All these and m a n y other thoughts, came to my mind during my long solitary hours in Badenweiler. I did not shed the atmosphere of jail easily; I h a d long got used to it and the new environment did not make any great change. I was living in the nazi domain with all its strange happenings which I disliked so much, but nazism did not interfere with me. There were few evidences of it in that quiet village in a corner of the Black Forest.

Or perhaps my mind was full of other matters. My past life unrolled itself before me and there was always K a m a l a standing by. She became a symbol of Indian women, or of woman herself. Sometimes she grew curiously mixed up with my ideas of India, that land of ours so dear to us, with all her faults and weaknesses, so elusive and so full of mystery. W h a t was K a m a l a ? Did I know h e r ? understand her real self? Did she know or understand m e ? For I too was an abnormal person with mystery and unplumbed depths within me, which I could not myself fathom.

Sometimes I had thought thai she was a little frightened of me because of this. I had been, and was, a most unsatisfactory person